Youth

I was born into a family of humble clothmakers. My parents were respectable people, and their work supplied the armies with uniforms, banners and all manner of garments. There was a certain dignity in it, apparently. A good stitch here, a straight hem there, and uniform that made a hundred soldiers look like one.

I learned the trade well enough with my Mother teaching me embroidery, and Father handling the finer points of cutting and fitting. I could mend a tear before most children could tie their shoes.

I could never understand why everything had to be so terribly sensible. Why should a coat not have a little flair? Why should a sleeve not flow? Why should one not wear a little gold, a little colour, a little extravagance?

Naturally, I began making my own. I have always maintained that I was an excellent tailor. My parents, however, seemed to take issue with my choice of clientele, materials, and rather unconventional designs.

There were several incidents involving borrowed fabric, an unfortunate quantity of gold thread, and a particularly memorable pair of trousers. I shan't elaborate. I am bound by confidentiality after all, Rodin wouldn't want me saying any more than that.



The Doomsight

I remember the floor being terribly cold.

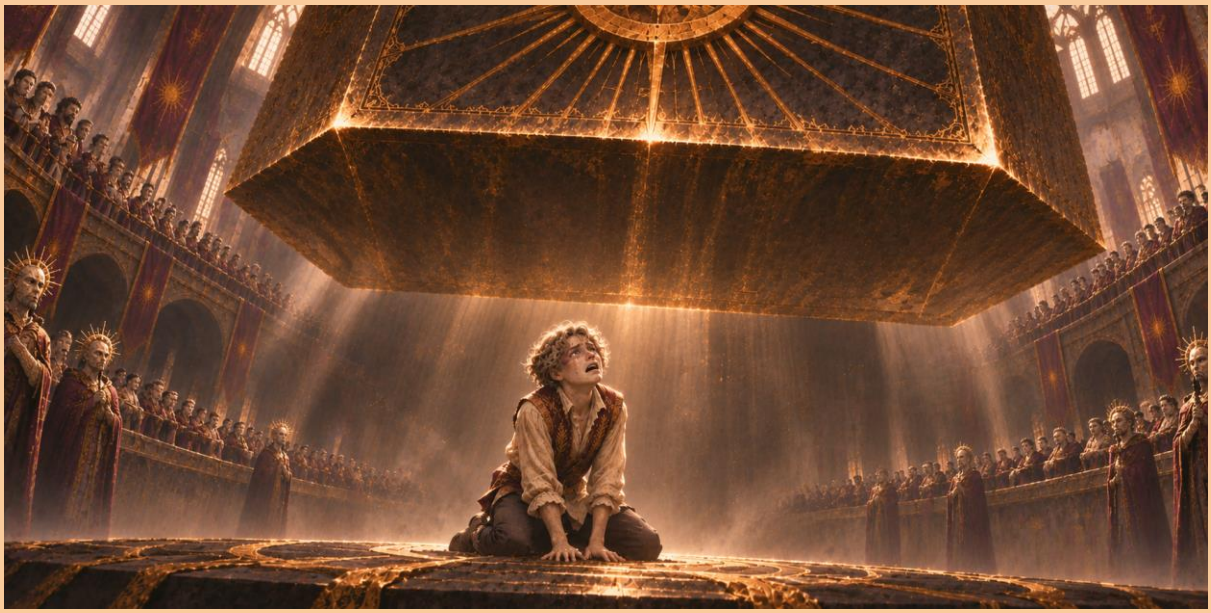
One moment I was standing, the next my body had seized and the world had disappeared. There was something in the darkness. A vision, a certainty. My death. I cannot say I understood it all. I remember fragments, sensations, an ending that felt as though it had already happened. When I came to, I was told I had received the Doomsight.

Well. How terribly inconvenient. Who would want to know their ending before the story had even begun?

I was to become Fated. At first, it seemed a dreadful prospect. But then I realised it wasn't all so bad. Finally, I had a perfectly good reason to leave. I was going to die regardless, wasn't I? Best get on with living, then.

I remember walking down the ceremonial aisle. I remember the weight of the room, the eyes upon me, and the Night's Fall - the Great Hammer of proclamation - looming overhead.

Finally, I stood in front of the lever with nowhere left to go. The moment felt so much more real when there was no escape. Honestly, I cowered away, and it so turns out that one does not get to choose to back out. There was an ominous grating sound of metal against metal. And then there was nothing.



I awoke, shattered and remade, now inlaid with gold along the fissures on my body. Father was there, but he didn't say all that much, as always. Mother had never shown up. I suppose she simply didn't want to watch her failure of a son, the one who would never take the reins, meet his end.

Oh well, that doesn’t matter now; what mattered was that I was finally free.

That was the important thing.

A Life of my own

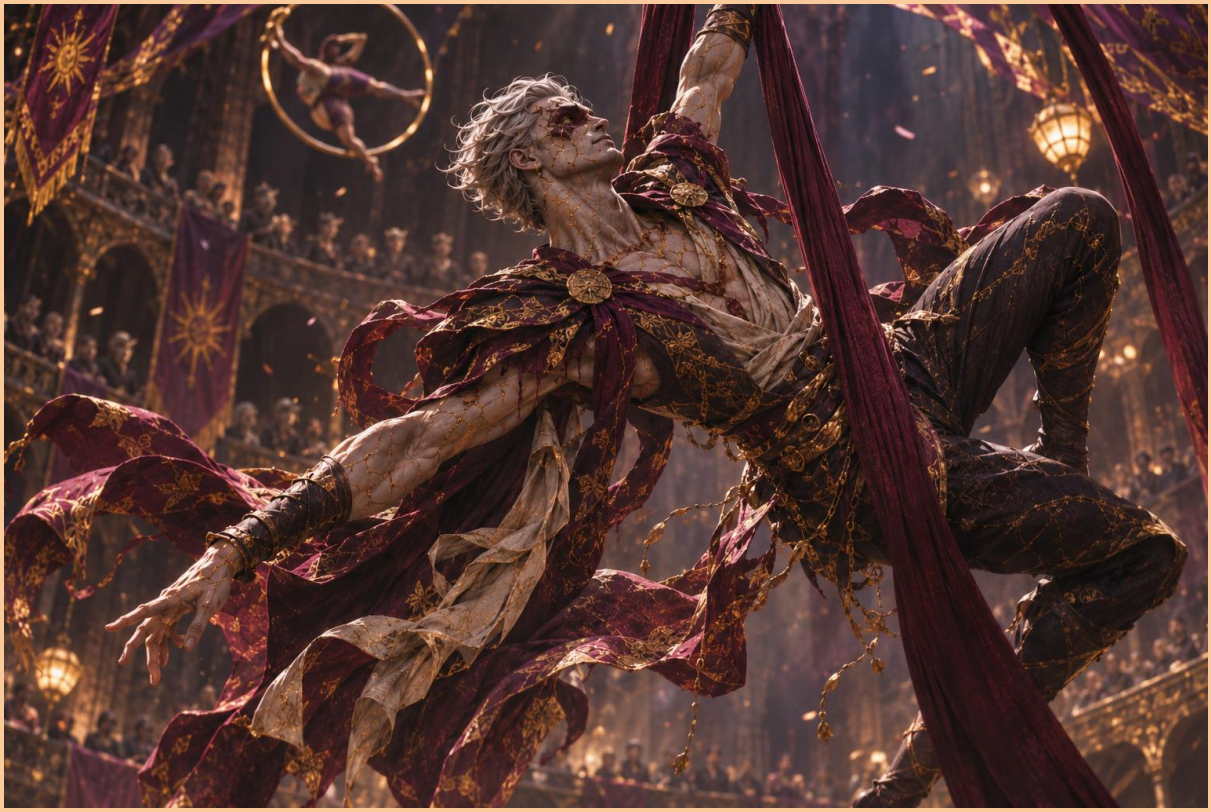
There is a great deal to be said for having no one to answer to. I have gambled away fortunes, stolen back twice as much, slept in places I wouldn't recommend to anyone, and worn clothes that would make my mother faint.

I've learned that most people see what they expect to see. A merchant sees a customer. A guard sees a suspicious stranger. A drunk sees a friend. And a particularly inattentive traveller might see nothing more than a rather convincing statue.

It is remarkable what one can get away with when one looks the part. I have made a living out of being someone else. A little tailoring, a little acting, a little misdirection. And when all else fails, a quick escape.

I have never been particularly short of company. Friends, however, are another matter.

The closest to that would be the Cirque d'Été. A hilarious bunch, although I wouldn't exactly trust them with a spare copper, let alone my life. Still, there are good stories to be had, and one meets all sorts of intriguing people performing at the balls and gatherings of the well off. Conveniently, it was also rather easy to make some extra coin taking jobs while we were there. I learnt pretty quickly that blending into a room makes it awfully easy to slide a blade between someone's ribs too.



While the Cirque d'Été paid a pretty penny, I wouldn't have stuck around if I'd known they were connected to my prophecy too! She didn't take kindly to me turning a blind eye every now and then. Long story short, our last disagreement ended rather poorly for me, I must admit. Woke up in a ditch, entirely penniless. Terrible service, really. Wouldn't recommend dying on their premises. Won't be coming back!

And so, here I am. A little poorer, a little more cracked, and perhaps a little wiser.